

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Middle School | Unit 7

Suffixes -ance & -ence



Today I am learning that the suffixes -ance and -ence often form nouns naming a state, quality, action, or result.

1 Learn the Meaning

The suffixes -ance and -ence often form nouns from a base or related word. The new noun may name a state, quality, action, or result.

attendance
act/state of attending

difference
state of being different

resistance
act/state of resisting

existence
state of existing

2 Build the Word

Use the base or related word and suffix to build the noun. Notice whether the word uses -ance or -ence.

Base / related	Suffix	New noun	What it names
assist	-ance		
attend	-ance		
resist	-ance		
exist	-ence		
differ	-ence		

3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

Our community science club planned an exhibition about how plants survive in difficult environments. Attendance was higher than expected, so everyone had to work with patience and confidence. At one table, students tested the resistance of different materials to water. Another group explained the importance of sunlight and showed the difference between seedlings grown in light and darkness. A display about desert plants described their dependence on stored water and the existence of tiny leaf hairs that reduce water loss.

During the event, several visitors asked questions, and the students offered assistance whenever someone needed help. Mia explained the science behind the results and gave clear explanations for why the plants showed resistance and how their environment made a difference. She showed real confidence as she spoke, and her patience helped younger students understand the information.

By the end of the afternoon, their confidence had grown. Their careful preparation made a real difference to the event, and the high attendance showed the importance of sharing accurate information. Before packing up, Mia recorded the attendance numbers and wrote a short reflection about the importance of clear explanations and how science helps us understand the existence and dependence of living things.



Highlight the -ance and -ence nouns. Underline the base or related word when you can identify one.

4 Word Detective

Choose one -ance or -ence noun from the passage and investigate its structure and meaning.

- Write an -ance or -ence noun from the passage.

- What base or related word can you identify?

- What does the noun mean in this context?

- Write a word sum or explain how the suffix forms a noun.

5 Sort the Words

Sort the nouns by their ending.

assistance attendance resistance importance
difference existence dependence confidence

Ends in -ance

Ends in -ence

6 Use It in Writing

Complete the sentence starters.

- The difference between two ideas can _____

- Use an -ance or -ence noun in your own sentence.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises the suffixes -ance / -ence
- ☐ Finds a base or related word
- ☐ Explains what the noun means
- ☐ Spells and uses derived nouns



Capture idea:

Find an -ance or -ence word in a book or information text. Record the related word and explain what the noun means.